

Phishing Email Investigation

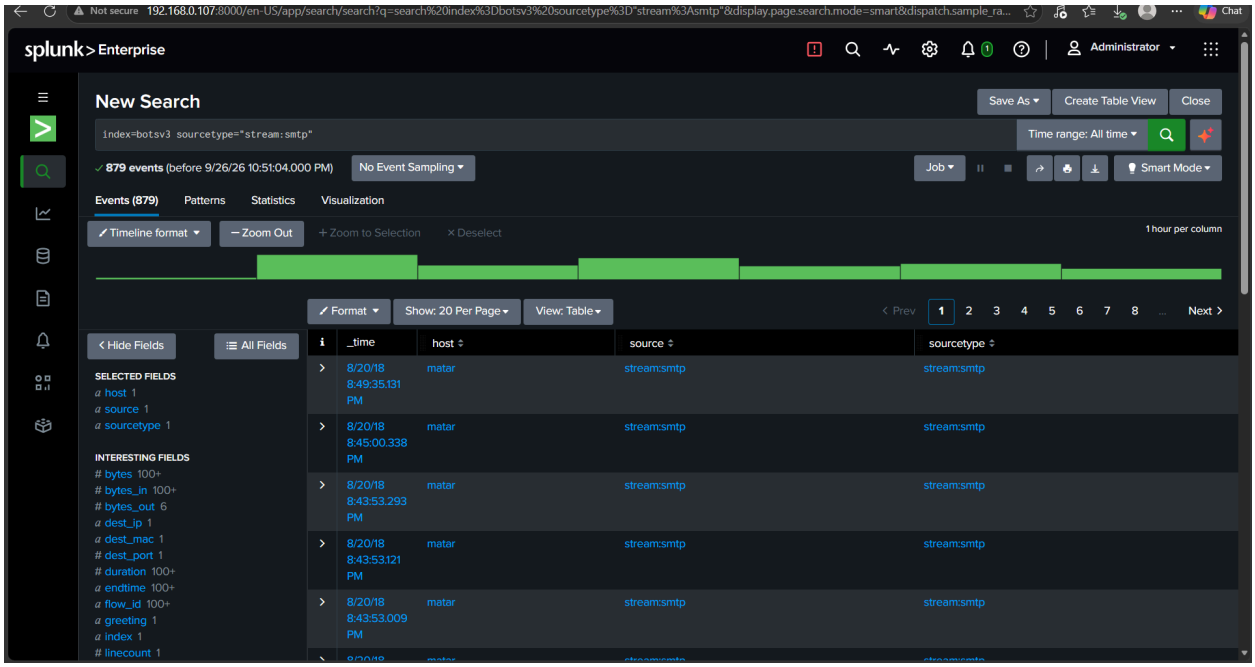
26.09.2026

Overview

This report documents the investigation of a suspicious email with the subject **“All your datas belong to us.”** The email originated from an external sender and contained a Pastebin URL and a PNG attachment. The investigation included Splunk-based event analysis, email header review, IOC extraction, threat-intelligence checks, attachment assessment, and MITRE ATT&CK mapping. Although the available threat-intelligence results did not identify the investigated URL, domain, or IP as malicious, multiple contextual indicators resulted in the email being assessed as **likely phishing**.

1. Alert

- Subject: *“All your datas belong to us.”*
- Trigger: Suspicious external email received for investigation

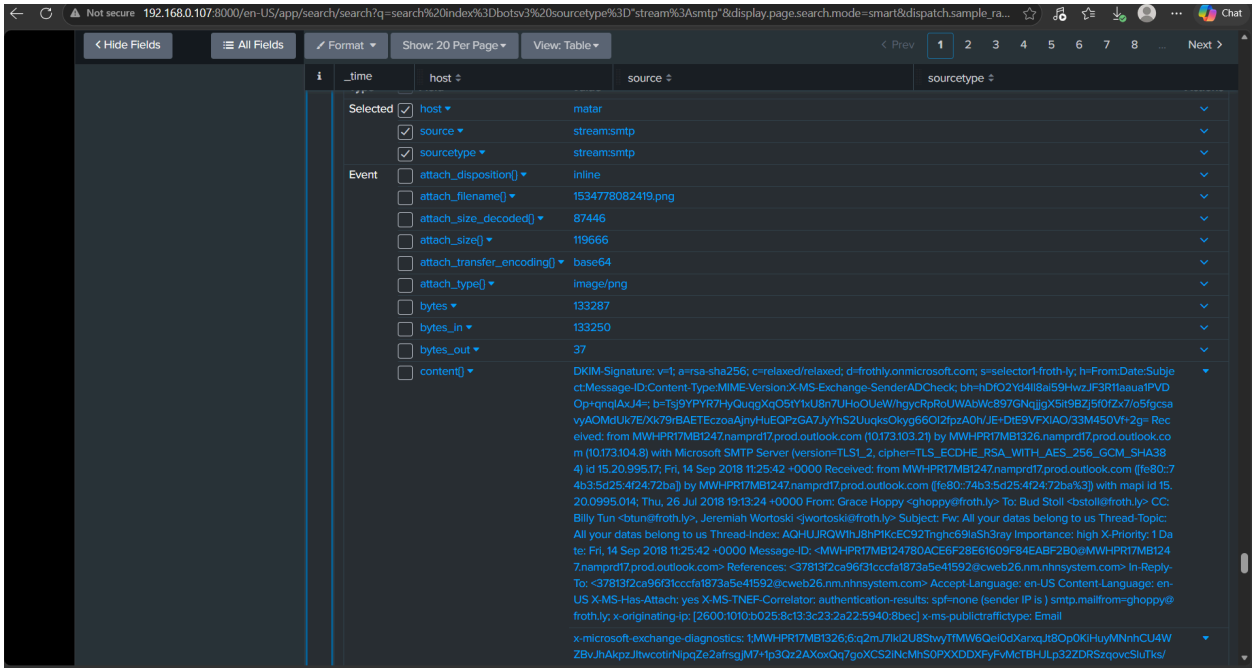


Screenshot 1: Splunk query result identifying the suspicious email event.

2.Evidence

a) Header Analysis

- **Sender:** hyunki1984@naver.com (external sender).
- **SPF:** `spf=none` — no SPF record was available for the sender domain.
- **DKIM/DMARC:** No corresponding authentication results were observed in the available event data.



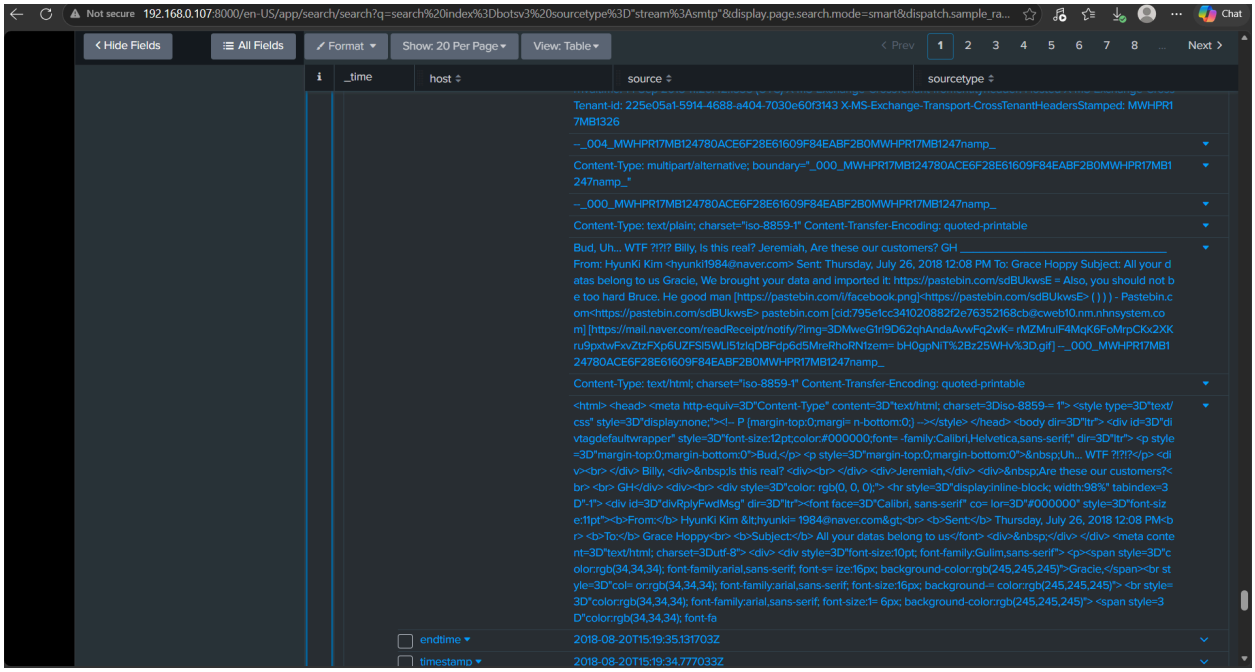
Screenshot 2: Expanded email event showing sender and email authentication-related fields.

b) Body Analysis

• The email contained an external Pastebin URL: `pastebin.com/sdBUkwsE`.

• The subject line, **“All your datas belong to us,”** uses threatening language and was treated as a suspicious indicator.

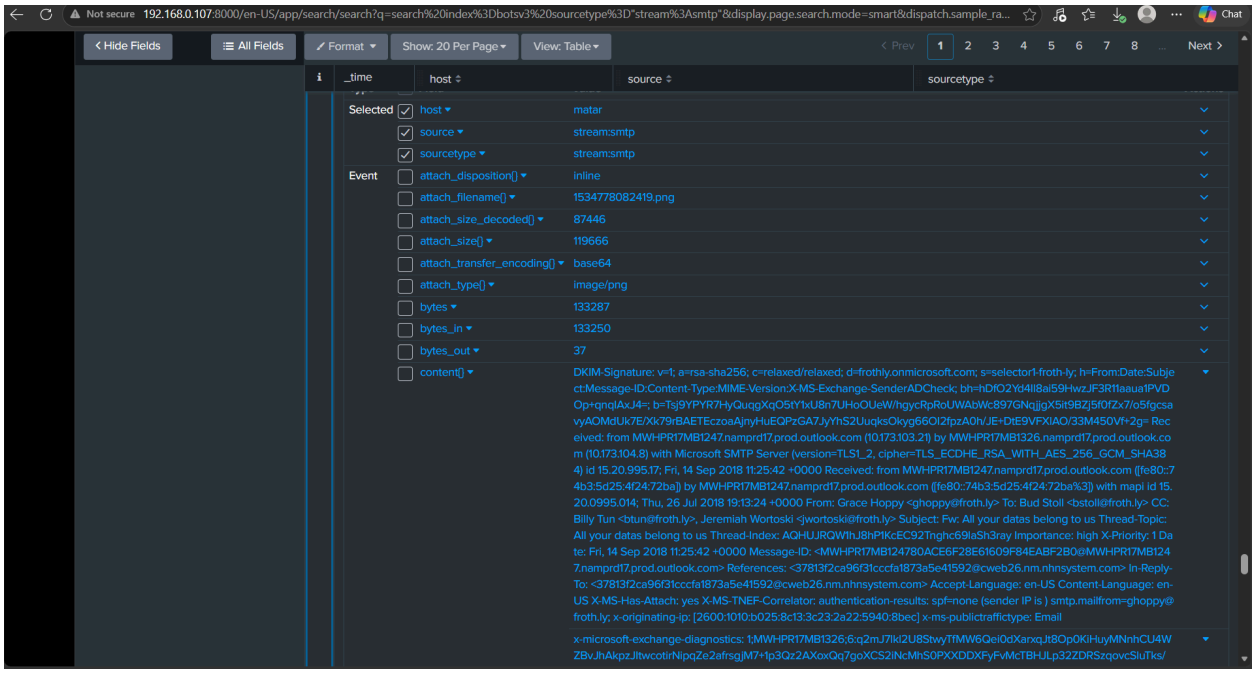
• The URL was reviewed as part of the IOC and threat-intelligence analysis.



Screenshot 3: Email event showing the message content and embedded URL.

c) Attachment Analysis

- **File:** 1534778082419 . png
- **Assessment:** Unexpected image attachment requiring further analysis. No malicious verdict was available from the current analysis.



Screenshot 4:Splunk event showing the attachment metadata associated with the suspicious email.

d) IOC Extraction

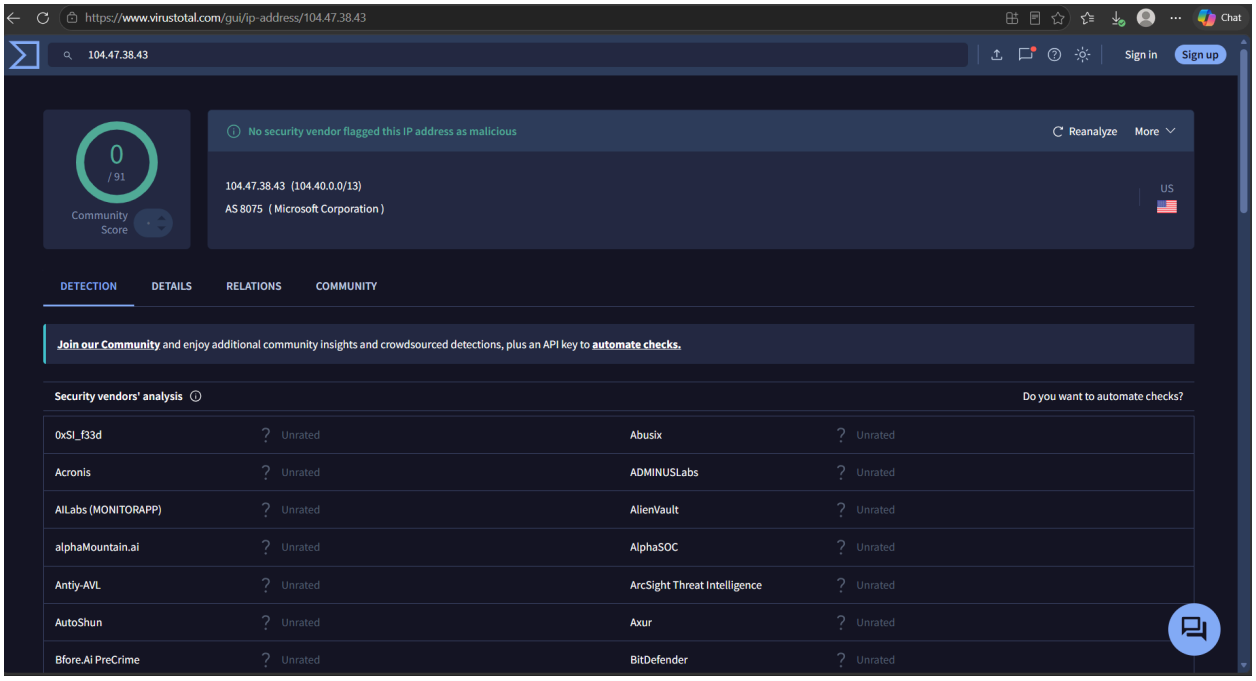
The following indicators were extracted from the email for further investigation: sender address, domain, URL, IP address, and attachment filename.



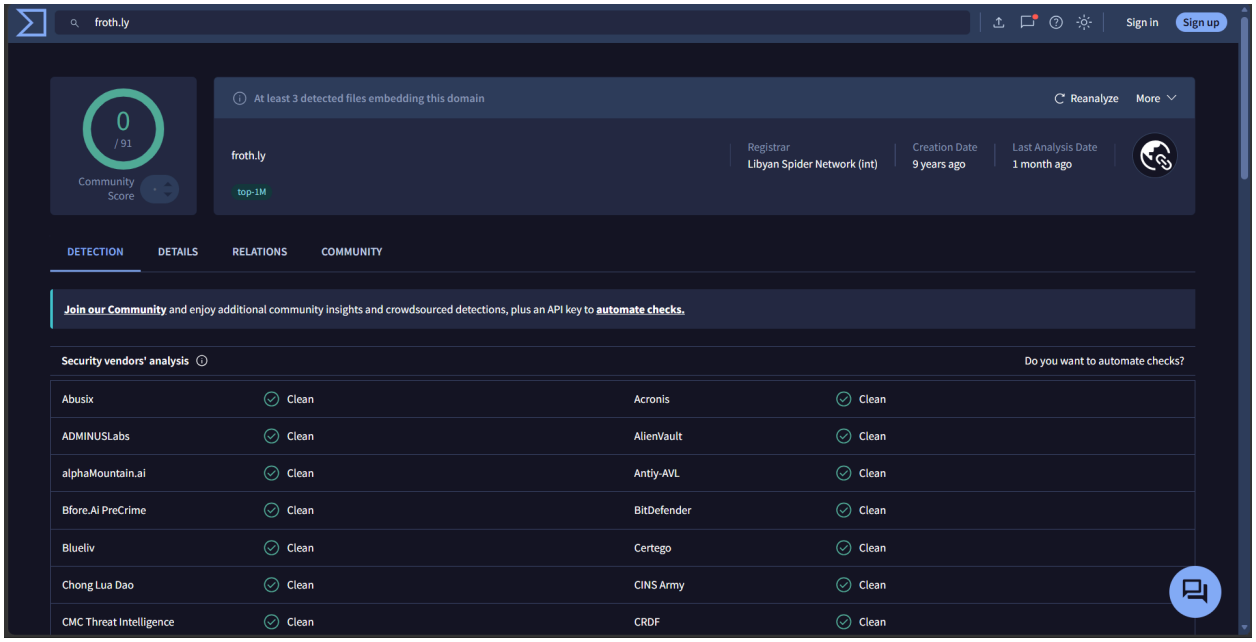
Table 1: Extracted indicators of compromise (IOC) identified during the email investigation.

3.Threat Intelligence

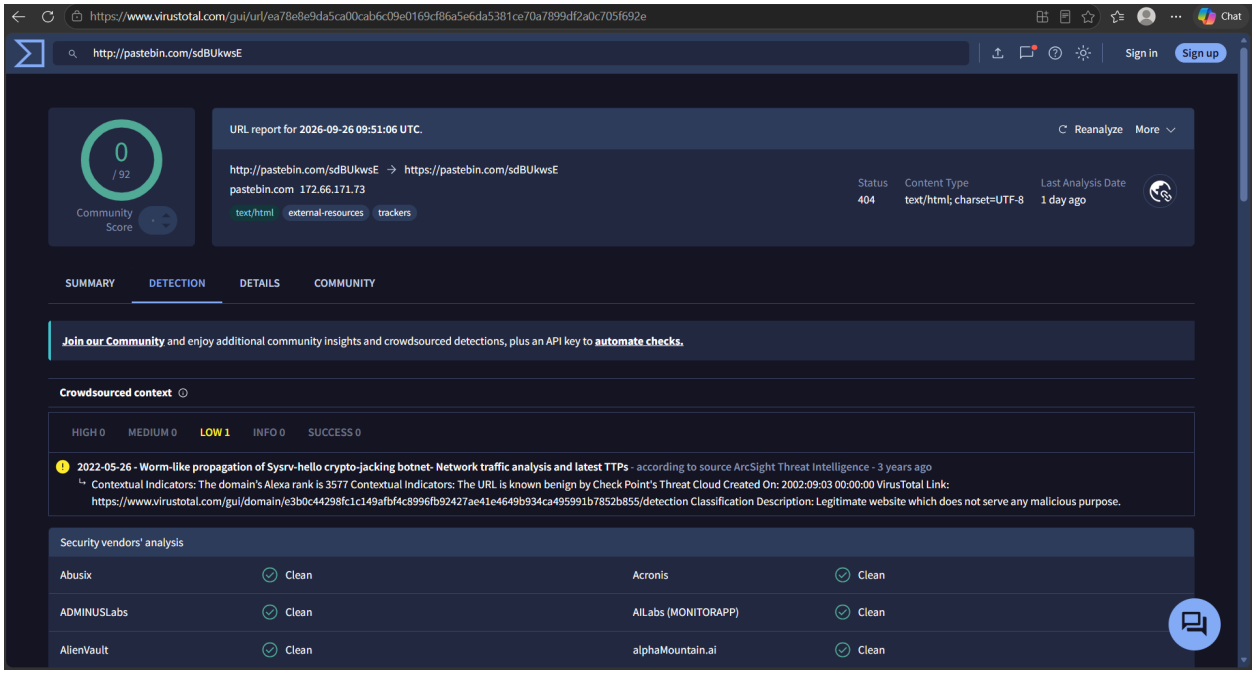
- **URL:** The Pastebin URL did not return a malicious verdict during the available scan and was reported as 404/unavailable.
- **Domain:** `naver.com` returned a clean result; the domain itself is legitimate, but the use of the domain does not by itself establish that the email is legitimate.
- **IP:** `104.47.38.43` was identified as Microsoft mail infrastructure and returned a clean result.
- **Attachment:** No useful threat-intelligence verdict was available for the attachment.



Screenshot5



Screenshot6



Screenshot 7

Screenshot 5-7: Threat-intelligence results for the investigated IP address, domain, and URL.

Threat Intelligence Commentary:

Clean threat-intelligence results do not by themselves establish that an email is legitimate. Phishing emails may contain legitimate domains or infrastructure, so technical indicators should be evaluated together with the email context, authentication results, message content, and user activity.

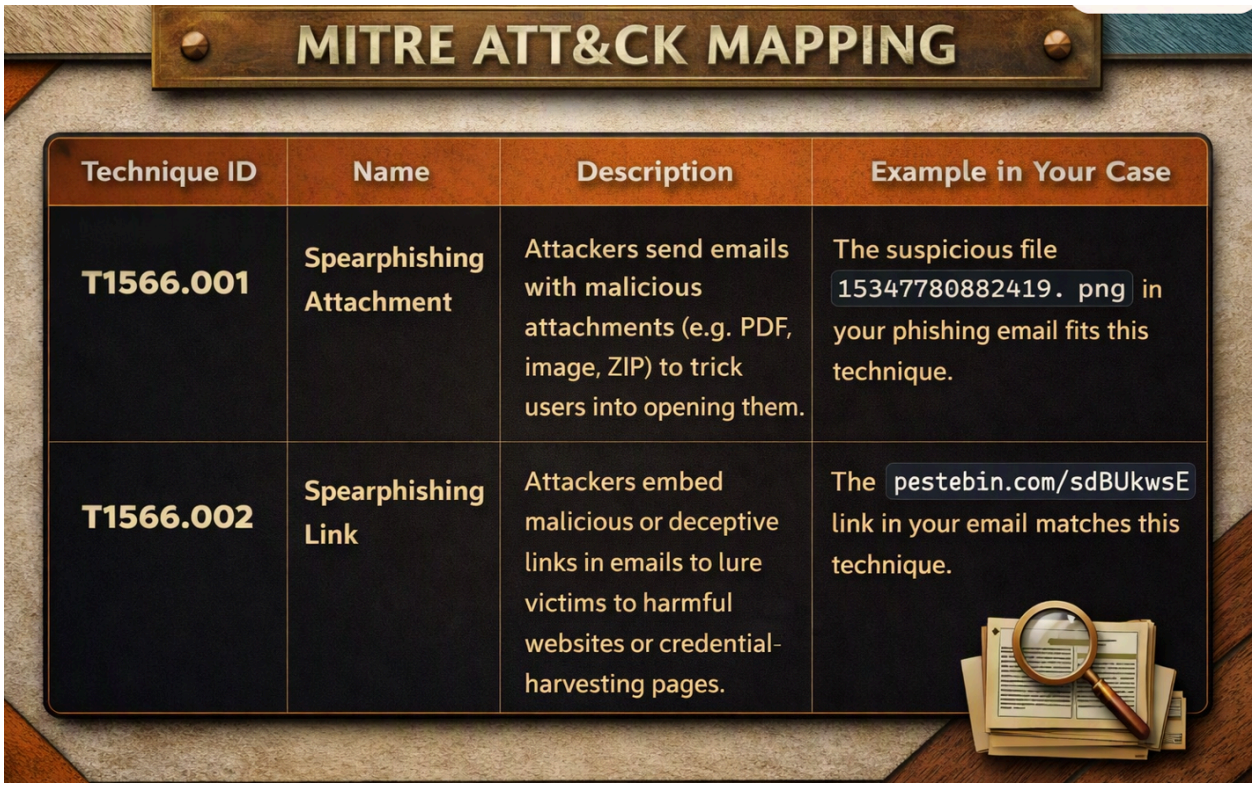
4.MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

T1566.001 – Spearphishing Attachment

- The suspicious email contained an unexpected PNG attachment named `1534778082419.png`. The presence of an attachment is consistent with the MITRE ATT&CK Spearphishing Attachment technique. However, the available evidence did not establish that the PNG file itself was malicious.

T1566.002 – Spearphishing Link

- The suspicious email contained the external URL `pastebin.com/sdBUkwsE`. The inclusion of an external link in the suspicious email is consistent with the Spearphishing Link technique. The available URL scan did not return a malicious verdict, so the URL should be treated as suspicious rather than confirmed malicious.



Technique ID	Name	Description	Example in Your Case
T1566.001	Spearphishing Attachment	Attackers send emails with malicious attachments (e.g. PDF, image, ZIP) to trick users into opening them.	The suspicious file `15347780882419. png` in your phishing email fits this technique.
T1566.002	Spearphishing Link	Attackers embed malicious or deceptive links in emails to lure victims to harmful websites or credential-harvesting pages.	The `pestebin.com/sdBUkwsE` link in your email matches this technique.

Table 2: MITRE ATT&CK mapping of observed phishing-related techniques.

5.Severity Assessment

Risk Level: Medium–High

Factors increasing risk:

- Suspicious external sender
- Unavailable SPF authentication record (`spf=none`)

- No corresponding DKIM/DMARC results observed in the available event data
- Threatening/suspicious subject line
- External Pastebin URL
- Unexpected PNG attachment

Factors limiting confidence:

- The investigated URL did not return a malicious verdict
- The domain returned a clean result
- The investigated IP was identified as Microsoft mail infrastructure
- No malicious verdict was available for the attachment

Overall assessment:
The email is assessed as **likely phishing and should be handled as a suspicious security event pending further investigation.**

6.Recommended Response

- Quarantine the suspicious email and prevent further delivery of similar messages.
- Search the mail environment for other messages containing the same sender, URL, subject, or attachment.
- Identify all recipients and determine whether any users interacted with the email.
- Analyze the attachment in an isolated sandbox if available.
- Investigate the Pastebin URL and any associated redirects or network activity.
- Review endpoint and network telemetry for activity related to the email.
- Block or quarantine confirmed malicious indicators where appropriate.
- Strengthen SPF, DKIM, and DMARC controls to improve email authentication.

7.Conclusion

The investigated email contains multiple indicators associated with phishing, including a suspicious subject line, an external sender, unavailable SPF authentication, an external Pastebin URL, and an unexpected PNG attachment.

The available threat-intelligence results did not identify the investigated URL, domain, or IP address as malicious, and no malicious verdict was available for the attachment. Based on the available evidence, the email is assessed as **likely phishing rather than confirmed malicious activity**.

The observed email characteristics were mapped to MITRE ATT&CK techniques **T1566.001 – Spearphishing Attachment** and **T1566.002 – Spearphishing Link**.